

The Program Control link can be used to set the behaviour of the firewall when a program tries to access the Net. The free version does not allow the highest setting, which can be used in the paid version to check abuse of trusted applications—as with CPF. Under the Programs tab, trustworthy applications that are to be given network access are listed, along with the scope of permission. In case the permissions given to certain applications need to be modified, you can do it here.

An anti-virus monitoring tab allows ZA to work with an installed AV to alert you if the AV has been compromised. On the reviewer's system that had both AVG and Avast!, ZA failed to detect either. And since the AV is capable of alerting the user to newer updates, the point of this module is lost. It's there probably to advertise ZA's own AV product.

Overall, a download size of 40 MB might make it seem like ZoneAlarm is more feature-rich, but it seems to offer much less than does CPF (whose installer is less than half the size).



ZoneAlarm also pops up alerts like this one (when data tries to get into your PC)